Faculty Undergraduate Research Practice (FURP)

Kickoff Meeting — Rules, Workflow & Expectations

Undergraduate Research Group

Faculty of Science and Engineering
University of Nottingham Ningbo China

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FURP-Handbook

Today's Agenda

1. What is FURP?
2. Participation tiers & certificate
3. **The 3 rules that matter most**
4. Project tracks
5. GitHub & Agile workflow
6. Weekly cadence
7. Leave & withdrawal policy
8. Timeline & next steps

Bridging the gap between classroom knowledge and cutting-edge research.

What is FURP?

Faculty Undergraduate Research Practice

A hands-on programme giving undergraduates real research experience — applying classroom knowledge, exploring research fields, and producing genuine academic output.

Applied

Turn theory into real-world research problems.

Explore

Discover your interests and build research skills.

Output

Contribute to papers, patents & showcase posters.

Since 2011: from **11 students / 11 projects** to **717 students / 248 projects** (2023–24) — 4,000+ alumni.

Participation Tiers & Certificate Eligibility

Role	Privileges	Certificate
First-time Participant	Full research access & mentorship	✔
Continuing Participant	Leadership & mentorship roles	✔
Volunteer	Hands-on experience only	✘

Volunteers *may* join future rounds to earn a certificate, but are **not** certified in the current round.

The Three Rules That Matter Most

To earn your FURP certificate, ALL three must be satisfied

1

Attend $>$ **50%** of activities

2

Submit a poster

3

Show up at the Poster Showcase

The next slides break each one down.

Rule 1 — Attendance: Over Half of All Activities

The requirement

You must attend **more than 50%** of programme activities — weekly meetings, workshops, and scheduled sessions (online or in person).

- Attendance is tracked across the whole programme cycle.
- Both **online** and **in-person** sessions count.
- Falling below the threshold means **no certificate**, regardless of other work.
- Approved leave (see Rule on Leave) is handled separately — communicate early.

⚠ *Showing up consistently is the single easiest box to tick. Don't lose your certificate on attendance.*

Rule 2 — Submit Your Poster

The deliverable

Every certificate-eligible participant must produce and submit a **research poster** summarising their FURP project.

What to do

- Prepare a poster (or presentation PDF) of your findings.
- Place the file in your repo root as `FURP_Showcase.pdf`.
- Individual *or* team posters are both accepted.

It will be evaluated

- Reviewed by an academic panel on-site.
- Awards: **Best Poster** (1st / 2nd / 3rd) & **Most Popular** (audience vote).

Submission + presence at the Showcase together complete Rules 2 & 3.

Rule 3 — Be Present at the Poster Showcase

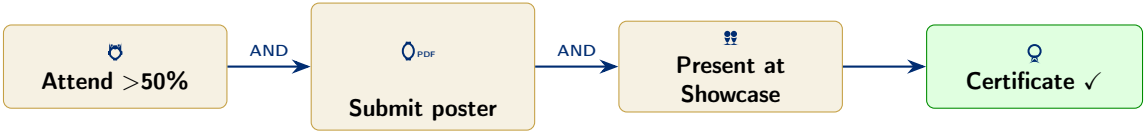
The requirement

Your poster must be **presented at the Showcase** — either by you in person, or by a stand-in if you genuinely cannot attend.

- **In person** is strongly preferred — it's your stage to shine and engage with the audience.
- If you truly cannot make it, **arrange someone to present on your behalf**.
- A submitted poster that nobody presents does **not** satisfy this rule.
- Last year: 80+ students presented; works have gone on to win Red Dot Awards and more.

ⓘ *No-show with no stand-in = requirement not met. Plan your Showcase day in advance.*

Certificate Logic at a Glance



All three conditions are **required**. Miss any one, and the certificate is not awarded this round.

Project Tracks

Research Track

For students who want to go deeper.

- Team-based open problems
- Novel method exploration
- Benchmarking & validation

Minimum for Certification

Successful **replication of a cited paper** with at least **10% innovation** — reproduce the work *and* add something new.

Switching tracks? Email the project lead with subject *"Project Transfer Request"* and CC your supervising faculty member.

GitHub Workflow — Repository Setup

We run on **Agile** project management, using GitHub for tracking.

Naming convention

```
[FURP-2025]/YourName-ProjectTag
# e.g.  furp-2025/Jason-ROSBootcamp
```

Mandatory folder structure

```
/docs
|- 00_weekly.md
|- meeting_notes/
/src
FURP_Showcase.pdf
```

- `00_weekly.md` — update **every week**: progress, challenges, next steps.
- `meeting_notes/` — key takeaways from all team meetings.
- `FURP_Showcase.pdf` — your poster/PDF, in the **repo root**.

Weekly Cadence & Expectations

Every Week

- Update `00_weekly.md`
- Log meeting notes
- Attend the weekly meeting (online or in person)

Why it matters

- Keeps your progress visible
- Surfaces blockers early
- Feeds directly into attendance (Rule 1)

Consistent weekly engagement is the backbone of a successful FURP project.

Leave & Withdrawal Policy

Email is mandatory

Any **leave of absence** or **withdrawal** from the programme **must be notified to us by email**. A verbal or chat message is not sufficient.

Requesting leave

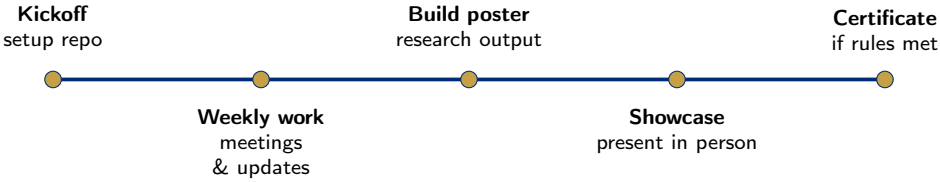
- Email **before** the session where possible.
- State the date(s) and reason.
- Remember: leave still counts against the >50% attendance rule.

Withdrawing

- Email us to formally withdraw.
- This frees your project slot for others.
- Lets us update records and mentoring.

No email = no record. Always put leave and withdrawal in writing.

Your FURP Journey



Throughout: keep attendance >50%, update GitHub weekly, and email us for any leave.

Key Takeaways

1. **Attend more than half** of all activities — non-negotiable for the certificate.
2. **Submit a poster** (`FURP_Showcase.pdf`) summarising your research.
3. **Present at the Showcase** — in person, or send a stand-in.
4. **Update GitHub weekly**: `00_weekly.md` + meeting notes.
5. **Email us** for *any* leave or withdrawal — always in writing.

Attend >50% + Submit poster + Present = Certificate

Let's get started!

Questions?

Undergraduate Research Group
Faculty of Science and Engineering, UNNC

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